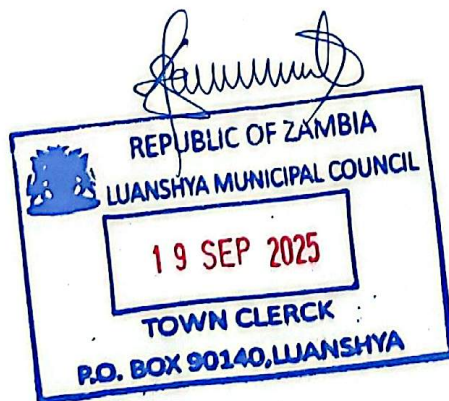




REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA
MINISTRY OF LOCAL GOVERNMENT AND RURAL DEVELOPMENT

LUANSHYA MUNICIPAL COUNCIL CITIZEN ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY

(With a focus on Output Based Budgeting (OBB) and Project
Implementation Management (PIM))



Zambia Devolution Support Program
2025

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1. Introduction

1.1 Background

Luanshya Municipal Council values stakeholder engagement at all levels of implementing the Local Authority's Programs. By outlining the methods, timelines various stakeholders, this plan demonstrates the need to ensure stakeholder involvement, understating and ownership of projects as budgeted for by the local authority and ensure the upholding of democratic principles of governance. The plan further demonstrates the Local authority's commitment to the implementation of the Government Decentralisation agenda by implementing the Decentralization Policy and the Local Government Act No. 2 of 2029 and endeavours to achieve the goal to empower citizens, improve decision-making, and foster trust between government and the public.

1.2 Current C.E. Efforts by Luanshya Municipal Council

Luanshya Municipal does not work in isolation; the Local Authority has engaged various stakeholders at various levels notable among others in the following initiatives:

- **Community sensitization programs:** sensitization programs are conducted to inform stakeholders and get feedback on ongoing projects using the weekly community radio program, review meetings and social media platforms such as the website and the Luanshya Municipal Council Facebook page.
- **Stakeholder feedback mechanism:** These include suggestion boxes and the implementation of the Service charter.
- **By implementing the stated strategies,** the Local Authority fosters a collaborative environment, before, during and after budget preparation and implementation of all project life cycles.

2. Vision, Aim and Objectives

2.1 Vision :

"Economically diversified, inclusive and transparent green city by 2028"

2.2. Aim

The main aim of this Strategy is to provide a structured approach for engaging citizens in the budget and project cycle processes to enable transparency, accountability, and inclusivity in the public financial management of the council.

2.3 Objectives

- Increase current levels of citizen awareness and understanding of the budget and project cycle processes.
- Enable more inclusion of citizens to participate in budget and project decision-making and prioritization.
- Improve mechanisms for citizen monitoring of budget and project implementation from current practice.
- Building consensus on development priorities
- Strengthening trust between the Local authority and citizens

3. Approaches and Methods of Engagement

The Luanshya Municipal Council team will use the below stated initiatives for inclusive engagement taking into consideration that citizens are drawn from varying contexts. Consideration will be taken about how citizens will engage with civic leaders as well, to ensure that the process is not one sided. The citizen engagement process is on-going, hence the Councils intention to use different avenues and mechanisms to communicate with various stakeholders. Engagement methods will therefore include:

A. Citizen Participation in key Decision-Making and keeping citizens informed through the budget cycle: - The presentation for the budget hearings will be made ahead of time to stakeholders to obtain feedback including allocations to different programs/sub programs, key outputs, and selected projects; - The CE in prioritizing projects will be strengthened to provide a good venue for informed consultation with WDCs. B. Citizen Monitoring of Budget and Project Implementation - CE in project implementation will be fostered via updated openings to engage citizens and local structures in monitoring project implementation; - Improve reporting to citizens on the outputs of the budget implementation. This will be achieved using the following examples: - Use technology for real-time reporting on project progress; - Publish regular updates and reports; - Create accessible channels for concerns or feedback. - Selected stakeholders will form part of the team as the council conducts monitoring visits. - Citizen Monitoring of Budget and Project Implementation C. Inclusiveness and sensitivity: Stakeholders identification has been performed to enhance communication and establish effective relationships with the local authority. The participation process the programs and projects will be inclusive, encouraging all relevant stakeholders to participate in consultations. The local authority will endeavour to ensure equal access to information as well as sensitivity to stakeholders needs in the selection of stakeholders engagement methods. Special consideration will be given to vulnerable groups at greater risk of exclusion such as the women, the elderly, the differently abled and the youth. D. Flexibility Engagement methods will consider the socio-cultural contexts that may hinder the traditional face-to-face interactions such as gender dynamics, literacy levels and limited access to technology based communications modes.	
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4. Implementation Plan

Citizen engagement is vital for effective and responsive local governance as it promotes transparency, accountability, inclusivity, and effectiveness; thereby strengthening the relationship between citizens and the Local authority. As we embark on implementing this plan, the progress made in engaging our citizens cannot be overlooked, we wish to acknowledge the sub-district structures such as the Ward Development Committees (WDCs) and others who have been part of the Budget preparation and implementation of various programs and projects in the District. This Citizen engagement plan therefore seeks to create mechanisms, platforms and opportunities that will facilitate meaningful interactions between citizens, the local government and all relevant stakeholders. By successfully implementing this plan, we are confident that our citizens will be actively engaged and become partners in the development and progress of our communities, leading to a more vibrant and prosperous Luanshya District.

Luanshya Municipal Council has identified the following stakeholders to be engaged during the implementation of this CEP: Citizens, Ward Development Committees (WDCs), Community Welfare Assistance Committees (CWACs), Satellite Disaster Management Committees (SDMCs), government agencies (DDCC members) at various levels, Civil Society Organizations, community organizations, the business community, academic institutions, media outlets, and potentially affected groups within the community.

Table 1: Proposed Stakeholder Engagement Plan Summary Table

BUDGET STAGE	KEY FEATURES/ACTIVITIES	STAKEHOLDER CATEGORY INVOLVED	TIMELINE
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Preparation for budget formulation	i.	LAs provide communities with CEP giving proposed dates for consultation.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, members, Community members	Third quarter
	ii.	LAs provide WDCs with a list of proposed projects for consideration in this budget cycle as well as a list of ongoing projects and completed projects for the past 2 years.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, members, Community members	Fourth quarter
	iii.	Using the project lists provided, communities may accept or reject project proposals and make their own proposals for development projects and activities for their Wards to be included in the budget based on their priorities	Councillors, Civil society organisations, the business community, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	Fourth quarter
	iv.	LAs produce a summarized stakeholder report from all Wards and submit report to MLGRD.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	Fourth quarter
	v.	Conduct budget hearings & Town Hall meetings.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	Fourth quarter
	vi.	The Town Clerk shall present the reports to the full council.	Councillors, Government agencies	Fourth quarter
	vii.	Feedback meetings to WDCs on what projects and activities have been included in the budget.	WDCs	Fourth quarter
	viii.	Reports including minutes submitted to the PLGOs office for review and consolidation for onward submission to MLGRD.	Management	Fourth quarter
	ix.	MLGRD will submit the consolidated reports to MoENP.	Management, MLGRD	Fourth quarter
Budget approval (public awareness of budget details)	i.	Review the proposed budget and assess whether input from community, especially vulnerable groups i.e. women, PWDs and children has been incorporated.	MLGRD	Fourth quarter
	ii.	Feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders of the final approved budget.	WDCs	First quarter
Budget execution and monitoring (for transparency in budget implementation)	i.	Track the effective utilisation of funds in line with planned activities.	Management	Quarterly
	ii.	Report back on a regular basis to WDCs on implementation of activities and projects.	Management	Quarterly
Budget evaluation and Review	i.	Evaluate the impact of allocated funds, focusing on agreed upon programmes with a bias towards gender, persons with disabilities, child-related and climate change outcomes.	Management	Quarterly

5. Communication Plan

The communication plan describes information dissemination by the council to create awareness over the CEP and its contents. It outlines details of different avenues to announce meeting details such as timing as well as Grievance Redress Mechanism to capture feedback from citizens.

Table 2: Proposed Communication Plan Summary

DELIVERABLE/ ACTIVITY	TARGET STAKEHOLDERS	FREQUENCY	PROPOSED TIMELINE/ DATE	RESPONSIBILITY	COMMUNICATION METHOD	COMMENTS
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Luanshya Municipal Council provide communities with EP giving proposed dates for consultation	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	1	Third quarter	DF, PRM	DDP, Hold community engagement meetings Publish on the Council Website, publish in the newsletter and Luanshya Municipal Council Facebook page	None
LAs provide WDCs with a list of proposed projects for consideration in this budget cycle as well as a list of ongoing projects and completed projects for the past 2 years.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	2	Fourth quarter	DF, PRM, DES	DDP, Hold community engagement meetings	None
Using the project lists provided, communities may accept or reject project proposals and make their own proposals for development projects and activities for their Wards to be included in the budget based on their priorities	Councillors, Civil society organisations, the business community WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	1	Fourth quarter	DF, PRM, DES	DDP, Written letters	None
Luanshya Municipal Council produce a summarized stakeholder report from all Wards and submit report to MLGRD.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	1	Fourth quarter	Council Management and support staff	Written letters, Publish on the Council Website, publish in the newsletter and Luanshya Municipal Council Facebook page	None
Conduct budget hearings & Town Hall meetings.	Councillors, WDCs, CWACs, SDMCs, Community members	2	Fourth quarter	DF, PRM, DES	DDP, Hold community engagement meetings	None

The Clerk shall present the reports to the full council.	Councillors, Government agencies, community members	1	Fourth quarter	Council Management and support staff	Council booklets through Councillors	minute shared Ward	None
Feedback meetings to WDCs on what projects and activities have been included in the budget	WDCs	1	Fourth quarter	DF, DDP, PRM, DES	Written Publish Council newsletter Luanshya Municipal Facebook page as well as radio program	letters on the Website, in the Council page as radio	None
Reports including minutes submitted to the PLGOs office for review and consolidation for onward submission to MLGRD.	Council Management and support staff	1	Fourth quarter	Council Management and support staff	Council booklets through Councillors	minute shared Ward	None
MLGRD will submit the consolidated reports to MoFNP.	MLGRD	1	Fourth quarter	PLGO	Council booklets shared	minute shared	None
Review the proposed budget and assess whether input from community, especially vulnerable groups i.e. women, PWDs and children has been incorporated.	MLGRD	1	Fourth quarter	PLGO	Council booklets shared	minute shared	None
Feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders of the final approved budget	WDCs	1	First quarter	Council Management and support staff	Reports published in newsletters, Council Website and facebook page.		None
Track the effective utilisation of funds in line	Council Management and support staff	4	Quarterly	Council Management and support staff	Reports published in newsletters, Council		None

with planned activities.					Website and facebook page.	
Report back on a regular basis to WDCs on implementation of activities and projects	Council Management and support staff	4	Quarterly	Council Management and support staff	Reports published in newsletters, Council Website and facebook page.	None
Evaluate the impact of allocated funds, focusing on agreed upon programmes with a bias towards gender, persons with disabilities, child-related and climate change outcomes.	Council Management and support staff	4	Quarterly	Council Management and support staff	Reports published in newsletters, Council Website and facebook page.	None

6. Budget (for the Implementation of the CE Process)

Luanshya Municipal Council will ensure consideration for the inclusion of budget lines to support the implementation of the Citizen Engagement Plan. Currently, citizen engagement initiatives are budgeted for under Local Governance and Constituency Development Fund (CDF) programs.

7. Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

This provides a detailed account to monitor, report and evaluate progress, adjusting based on feedback and lessons learned from implementing the CE action plan.

- It will also include the commitment towards the use of the existent Feedback and Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) procedure to ensure for continuous flow of information over concerns or inquiries that may arise during the budget and project cycle phases.
- Monitoring Reports will be published via various platforms including the website, the Facebook page and notice board, etc.
- Percentage of stakeholders engaged per quarter, number of Community issues and complaints resolved
- Stakeholder satisfaction surveys

8. Conclusion

The successful development of Luanshya District depends on inclusive, consistent and transparent engagement of all stakeholders within the district, this CES is a roadmap for strengthening Luanshya Municipal Councils relationships with different stakeholders at various levels of governance and its implementation will enhance transparency, collaboration and Municipal service delivery.

